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Domain: AI and Autonomous Driver Assistive Systems (ADAS)

1. AI and Autonomous Systems Applications

Artificial Intelligence (AI) and Autonomous Driver Assistive Systems (ADAS) are transforming modern transportation by improving road safety, driving efficiency, and reducing human errors. These systems combine Computer Vision, Deep Learning, Sensor Fusion, and Machine Learning to perceive the driving environment, predict potential hazards, and assist drivers in making safer decisions.

Some major applications include:

- **Object Detection and Recognition:** Detects vehicles, pedestrians, cyclists, obstacles, and road infrastructure using computer vision.
- **Lane Detection and Lane Keeping Assistance:** Identifies Lane boundaries and provides steering assistance to keep vehicles within lanes.
- **Traffic Sign and Traffic Light Recognition:** Automatically recognizes road signs and traffic signal states to assist in navigation and compliance.
- **Adaptive Cruise Control (ACC):** Maintains a safe following distance by automatically adjusting vehicle speed.
- **Forward Collision Warning (FCW):** Predicts possible collisions and alerts the driver before impact.
- **Automatic Emergency Braking (AEB):** Applies braking automatically when an imminent collision is detected.
- **Driver Monitoring Systems (DMS):** Detects driver fatigue, distraction, or drowsiness using AI-based facial analysis.
- **Autonomous Navigation:** Uses AI algorithms to understand the surrounding environment and make driving decisions with minimal human intervention.
- **Simulation-Based ADAS Development:** Enables researchers to safely test autonomous driving algorithms in virtual environments such as CARLA without requiring physical vehicles.

2. Limitations in the Domain

Although ADAS technologies have made significant progress, several challenges remain:

- Existing systems are primarily reactive and often respond only after detecting immediate hazards.
- Performance decreases under adverse weather conditions such as rain, fog, or low-light environments.
- Computer vision models require large, high-quality annotated datasets for reliable performance.
- Dynamic traffic scenarios involving unpredictable pedestrian or vehicle behavior remain difficult to predict accurately.
- Most systems provide limited explainability, making it difficult to understand why specific decisions were taken.
- Real-time processing demands high computational resources, especially when multiple AI models operate simultaneously.
- Simulation results may not fully represent real-world driving conditions due to the "simulation-to-reality gap."

3. Future Scope

The future of AI-powered ADAS is expected to include:

- Predictive safety systems capable of anticipating hazards before they occur.
- Explainable AI (XAI) to improve transparency and user trust in autonomous systems.
- Integration with Vehicle-to-Everything (V2X) communication for cooperative driving.
- AI models capable of learning continuously from driving experiences.
- Digital Twin technology for real-time simulation and validation.
- Multi-sensor fusion combining cameras, LiDAR, radar, GPS, and IMU data for improved perception.
- Edge AI deployment for real-time inference inside vehicles.
- Fully autonomous driving systems with higher levels of automation (SAE Level 4 and Level 5).

II. Proposed Project Title

AI Safety Copilot for Autonomous Driving: A Computer Vision and Deep Learning-Based Predictive Driver Assistance System Using CARLA Simulation

Description

The proposed project aims to develop an intelligent AI Safety Copilot that continuously monitors the driving environment using Computer Vision and Deep Learning techniques within the CARLA Autonomous Driving Simulator. Unlike traditional ADAS systems that primarily react to detected obstacles, the proposed system predicts potential hazards, evaluates collision risks, and provides proactive safety recommendations.

The system will incorporate object detection, lane detection, traffic sign recognition, traffic light recognition, multi-object tracking, trajectory prediction, dynamic risk assessment, and an explainable AI-based decision engine. Since the project is entirely simulation-based, it eliminates the need for physical hardware while enabling realistic evaluation of autonomous driving scenarios.

III. Objectives to Achieve the Project

Objective 1

Develop a robust Computer Vision pipeline capable of detecting vehicles, pedestrians, lane boundaries, traffic signs, and traffic lights in real time using deep learning models.

Objective 2

Implement a multi-object tracking and trajectory prediction system to estimate the future movements of surrounding road users.

Objective 3

Design a dynamic risk assessment engine that analyzes traffic conditions, predicts potential collisions, and generates appropriate safety recommendations.

Objective 4

Develop an Explainable AI (XAI) decision-support module that provides transparent, human-readable explanations for every safety recommendation generated by the system.



Koneru Lakshmaiah Education Foundation

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Off-Campus: Bachupally-Gandimaisamma Road, Bowrampet, Hyderabad, Telangana - 500 043.

Phone No: 7815926816, www.klh.edu.in

Team Members:

	Name	Roll No
1.	RAYAPUREDDI RISHI SRICHARAN	2420030638
2.	CHITTARI SUMA PRIYA VARMA	2420030337
3.	TEJASWI KANNEKANTI	2420030517